MOH MAYA

World & Game Design Bible

A living-world simulation game about experiencing another life.

Project: Moh Maya
Version: 1.0 — Foundational Vision
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This document is the project's guiding Bible. It defines the experience, principles, scope, and rules that should remain true as the game evolves.

VERSION 1.1 — V1 EXECUTION MODEL AMENDMENT

Foundational vision preserved; pause-between-decisions model formally added.

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1. The Vision

Moh Maya is a browser-based simulation game in which the player lives another life inside a persistent, living world.

The player chooses a profession and an age at which they enter the world. The game then constructs a believable life behind that person: childhood, school, teenage years, education, relationships, family, work, experiences, and memories.

From that point onward, the player does not follow a pre-written protagonist story. They simply **live**. They meet people, talk to them, form relationships, make decisions, work, earn and spend money, experience events, and watch time pass.

> *The player is not the protagonist of the world. The player is a person living inside the world.*

Characters are driven by LLM-based agents where appropriate, but the goal is not merely to create convincing conversations. The goal is to create a world in which people have their own lives, knowledge, relationships, memories, motivations, and consequences.

2. The Core Promise

Moh Maya should make the player feel: “I did not complete a story. I actually lived a life.”

The world should feel larger than the player's awareness of it. Things happen that the player never sees. People have relationships the player does not know about. Characters have histories that are not automatically revealed. Events continue whether or not the player participates.

The central fantasy is not power, conquest, completion, or optimization. It is **existence inside a world that does not revolve around you.**

3. What Moh Maya Is — and Is Not

It is

• A life simulation with narrative emergence.

• A living world populated by characters with histories and relationships.

• A game where information is partial and perspective matters.

• A world that continues independently of the player.

• A system where stories emerge from interactions and consequences.

• A place where the player can create a unique life rather than follow one canonical plot.

It is not

• A traditional quest-driven RPG where everything exists to serve the player.

• A game where every NPC waits for the player to trigger their content.

• A single pre-written story disguised as a simulation.

• A world where the player automatically knows the hidden truth.

• A requirement that every person be equally deeply simulated.

• A giant collection of disconnected LLM conversations.

4. The Player's Life

At the beginning, the player chooses at least two foundational inputs:

• **Profession** — what the player does in the world.

• **Age** — the point in life at which the player enters the simulation.

The chosen age is not a blank slate. If the player enters at age 28, they have already lived 28 years.

The generated personal history

The game should generate a readable account of the player's life so far. It can include:

• Birth and family circumstances

• Parents and siblings

• School and childhood experiences

• Teenage years

• Friendships and important relationships

• Education or professional training

• Major successes and failures

• Losses, celebrations and memorable events

• Previous jobs and career development

• Important people from earlier stages of life

• Current circumstances at the moment the simulation begins

This history is not merely exposition. It establishes the player's memories and gives them a believable identity from which to continue living.

The player creates the future

The past can be generated. The future should primarily emerge.

The game should avoid presenting the player's life as a predetermined sequence of chapters. Once the simulation begins, the player chooses what to do, and the world reacts.

5. The World Exists Without the Player

The world does not move around the player.

This is one of the most important rules in the entire project.

Other characters work, travel, argue, fall in love, get married, lose jobs, become ill, make mistakes, make friends, change their minds, and experience events without waiting for the player.

If the player does not attend a friend's wedding, the wedding still happens. If they ignore a message, the sender reacts to being ignored. If they do not visit their parents for two years, the relationship may change. If they do not investigate something, they may never discover what happened.

The player can influence the world, but the world does not exist solely to provide content for the player.

6. Characters & Their Histories

Every character should have a history, even if that history is not fully materialized at the start.

A character should feel as though they existed before the player met them. At minimum, characters can have an identity and enough established facts to remain consistent.

History can exist at different depths

Established history: Facts already known to the world and safe to reference consistently.

Undiscovered history: Things that are true about the character but have not been revealed to the player.

Unmaterialized detail: Specific details that do not need to be generated until they become relevant to an interaction.

This allows the world to support a very large population without requiring every person's entire biography to be written upfront.

Dynamic story creation

When the player interacts with a character, additional history can be created dynamically. Once established, that information becomes part of the character's continuity.

Example: the player asks a café owner how he entered the business. The answer establishes that he previously worked in IT for 14 years. Later questions must respect that fact and build on it rather than inventing a contradictory past.

7. Active Characters

Some characters deserve significantly more depth because the player is likely to encounter them repeatedly or because they are important to the player's life.

Active characters should have detailed biographies, personalities, motivations, relationships, goals, fears, memories, secrets, current problems, and plans.

Examples include parents, siblings, partners, close friends, coworkers, bosses, neighbors, recurring business owners, important public figures, and characters who become important through play.

A character does not need to be designated important forever. A random stranger can become an active character naturally if the player keeps interacting with them or if events make them significant.

8. Knowledge, Memory & Information

The simulation knows more than the player.

The player should only know what their character has experienced, remembers, observes, or learns from another source.

This creates two realities:

• **Objective world:** What is actually happening.

• **Player's perceived world:** What the player believes is happening.

These can diverge.

Characters also have limited knowledge

A character can know something another character does not know. Characters can have incomplete information, misunderstand situations, forget things, make assumptions, gossip, hide information, exaggerate, or lie.

Deception should not be random. It should arise from personality, relationships, incentives, fear, pride, loyalty, embarrassment, self-interest, or misunderstanding.

Discovery is gameplay

The player may discover a relationship, conflict, secret, debt, betrayal, or past event simply by talking to people and connecting pieces of information.

The player might discover the truth. They might discover only one person's version. Or they might never discover it at all.

9. Relationships

Relationships are a central system, not merely a number such as “Friendship: 80.”

People can simultaneously love and resent each other, trust someone while disagreeing with them, depend on someone while fearing them, or care deeply about someone while being angry with them.

Relationships should evolve through experiences: arguments, favors, shared events, betrayal, support, absence, misunderstandings, achievements, loss, and time.

Relationships exist independently of the player

Characters can form and change relationships with one another even if the player never meets them.

This allows the world to contain hidden social structures and stories that exist outside the player's awareness.

10. Time & World Progression

Moh Maya needs a meaningful time system. Time should not be a decorative counter.

Daily life

Work, sleep, meals, travel, shops, schedules, appointments, social interactions and ordinary routines.

Weekly rhythms

Weekends, markets, social gatherings, regular activities and recurring commitments.

Monthly rhythms

Rent, bills, salaries, economic changes, recurring payments and local events.

Annual rhythms

Birthdays, anniversaries, festivals, holidays, seasons, elections and other recurring events.

Time should also change people. Careers progress, children grow, relationships evolve, health changes, opportunities disappear, and circumstances shift.

11. Events & the Gods

The world should have multiple sources of events.

Natural / emergent events

Events that arise from the state and behavior of the world: someone gets sick, loses a job, starts a business, gets married, has a conflict, or experiences an accident.

Scheduled world events

Known events that occur as part of the world's calendar: elections, festivals, holidays, seasonal changes, public events, and recurring traditions.

God events

Developer-created interventions. The developers are the “Gods” of the world and can introduce major events or scenarios.

Examples: a cyclone, a major political death, a bank collapse, a new law, a celebrity visit, a public scandal, or another large disruption.

God creates the event. God should not necessarily dictate all of its consequences.

For example, God can create a cyclone. The simulation determines who is affected, who helps, who profits, who loses property, who moves away, which relationships change, and what political consequences follow.

12. Currency & Economy

The world should have a currency and a basic economic system because money is a major part of everyday life.

People can have income, expenses, savings, debt, and assets. Employment should matter. Prices and financial pressure should influence decisions.

The initial economy should remain intentionally simple. The goal is to support believable life choices, not to become a full economic strategy simulator.

Economic depth can grow later if it creates meaningful consequences for people's lives.

13. Government & Democracy

The world should have a governing system, primarily democratic in the initial vision.

A simple initial model can include government, laws, taxes, public services, political candidates, elections, and public opinion.

The player can participate as a citizen. Other citizens can vote according to their own beliefs and circumstances.

Politics should affect the world without becoming the entire game. Detailed parliament simulation, complex constitutional systems, international diplomacy, and geopolitical simulation should remain outside the initial scope.

14. Character Tiers & Simulation Depth

Not every person should consume the same amount of simulation depth.

Background population

A large population that gives the world scale. These characters need basic identity and enough consistency to function in the world.

Active characters

A smaller population with richer state: profession, history, relationships, goals, schedules, finances, and meaningful participation in the world.

Deep characters

The most important recurring people, potentially including family, close friends, partners, bosses, and major recurring characters. They receive detailed personality, memory, motivations, secrets, goals, and nuanced interactions.

The key principle is not that some characters are “fake.” It is that the world allocates more detail where detail has more value.

15. The Player's Core Gameplay Loop

The fundamental loop is:

1	LIVE
2	MEET PEOPLE
3	TALK / INTERACT
4	LEARN THINGS
5	MAKE DECISIONS
6	PEOPLE REACT
7	WORLD CHANGES
8	TIME PASSES
9	NEW EVENTS OCCUR
10	LIVE

The game should not constantly interrupt this loop with quests or explicit objectives. A player's life can be driven by curiosity, responsibility, relationships, ambition, boredom, fear, opportunity, or simple impulse.

16. The World's History

The world should have existed before the player arrived.

If the player starts at age 28, the world should not feel like it was created on that day. Characters should have memories of earlier events. The city or society should have a past. Major events should have shaped people.

Example history:

• 2030 — Economic recession

• 2031 — Election

• 2032 — Major flood

• 2033 — New government

• 2034 — Economic recovery

• 2035 — Player enters the world

The player was not necessarily present for these events. They may learn about them through other people's memories, public records, conversation, or personal experience.

17. Foundational Design Rules

1. The world does not revolve around the player. The player participates in the world; the world does not exist solely to serve the player.

2. Every person has a past. Not every biography must be fully generated upfront, but every character should feel like a person who existed before the player met them.

3. The player only knows what they know. Never expose the simulation's hidden truth simply because it exists in the underlying world.

4. Characters have their own knowledge. Different characters can know different things and hold conflicting perspectives.

5. Established facts become canon. Dynamic history can be generated, but once established it must remain consistent.

6. Relationships exist without the player. NPCs can know, love, hate, trust, betray, help, and avoid each other independently.

7. Time must matter. People and circumstances should change as time passes.

8. The future should emerge. The player's future should not be a predetermined story.

9. God creates possibilities, not necessarily outcomes. Developer events should inject circumstances and let the world produce consequences.

10. Missing something is valid gameplay. The player can fail to notice, attend, understand, or discover things.

11. Conversation should reveal the world, not just deliver exposition. Dialogue should be one of the ways the player discovers reality.

12. Simulation depth should follow importance. Spend detail where it creates meaningful player experience.

18. V1 Scope

The first playable version should prove that one simulated year can feel like a life rather than a sequence of quests.

Recommended initial boundaries:

• One city or contained geographic region.

• One player.

• A meaningful population large enough to make the world feel inhabited.

• A smaller set of active characters.

• A small set of deeply simulated recurring characters around the player.

• A functioning passage of time.

• Player history generated before the simulation begins.

• Character histories and personalities.

• LLM-driven conversations and interactions.

• Basic money, employment, expenses and financial consequences.

• Health and basic life circumstances.

• Relationships between characters.

• A basic democratic government.

• Annual and recurring events.

• Random / emergent events.

• Developer-created God events.

• A world that continues when the player is not directly involved.

Explicitly keep out of the first version

• Complex combat.

• A huge procedural world.

• Full-scale economic simulation.

• Detailed international politics.

• Thousands of equally deep LLM agents.

• A giant quest system.

• Multiplayer.

• A large number of specialized gameplay systems that do not strengthen the life-simulation fantasy.

19. Example of Moh Maya in Action

Starting conditions: The player chooses “Doctor” and age 28.

The game presents the player's life so far: family, childhood, school, teenage experiences, education, friendships, important relationships, career development, major memories, and current circumstances.

The player begins living in the world. They know their own history but do not receive a database of everyone else's secrets.

They visit a café and meet Sanjay, a 43-year-old café owner. Sanjay already has a life. He has a family, a career history, relationships, opinions, and memories. Some of those facts are established before the player arrives; other details can be generated as the conversation makes them relevant.

The player asks how Sanjay became a café owner. Sanjay explains that he spent 14 years in IT before leaving the industry. That becomes established history.

The player later meets another character who knows Sanjay. They tell a different story about why he left his job. Neither person necessarily has the complete truth.

Meanwhile, Sanjay and another character can have a relationship that has nothing to do with the player. They may meet, argue, reconcile, or make decisions while the player is doing something else.

A cyclone hits the city as a God event. The player may be affected. Sanjay may be affected differently. Another character may profit from the disruption. A politician may gain or lose support because of the government's response.

An election occurs. The player votes or does not vote. Other citizens vote according to their own beliefs. The result changes the world.

A year later, the player can look back and see that their life did not follow a questline. It unfolded.

20. North Star

Moh Maya should create the feeling that the player was born into a world that was already alive, lived a life inside it, and left behind a history that continued after them.

The ultimate measure of success is not the number of quests completed, NPC conversations generated, or systems implemented.

The question is:

> *“Does the player believe that they actually lived?”*

If the answer is yes, the project is moving in the right direction.

If the world starts feeling like a stage built around the player, we have violated the core concept.

If NPCs feel like dialogue generators rather than people with their own lives, we have violated the core concept.

If the player can see the hidden truth of everything, we have weakened one of the game's most important sources of discovery.

If events only happen because the player triggers them, the world is no longer alive.

The systems, AI, interface, events, economy, government, relationships, and simulation should all ultimately serve one experience:

Live another life. In a world that does not belong to you.

MOH MAYA

World & Game Design Bible — Version 1.0

Created by **Victus**

This document captures the foundational design agreed for the project. Future features should be evaluated against the principles contained here.

MOH MAYA

World & Game Design Bible — Version 1.1

Foundational Vision · Execution Model Amendment

Version 1.1 — What Changed

This version preserves the foundational vision of Moh Maya while formally documenting the V1 execution model agreed during implementation. The world remains conceptually independent of the player: characters, relationships, events, history, resources and consequences do not exist solely to serve the player. However, **V1 does not run a continuously active or background simulation between player decisions.**

The simulation is therefore **paused between player decisions**. A player decision advances game time by its defined duration; the simulation processes that elapsed period; the resulting world state is persisted; and the world pauses again.

Amended Principle: World Independence vs. Simulation Execution

Moh Maya still treats the world as an autonomous world rather than a stage that waits for the player. NPCs have their own lives, knowledge, relationships, goals, schedules and circumstances. Events are not required to be created solely for the player, and the player remains only one person inside the world.

For **V1 execution**, however, world progression occurs only when the simulation is explicitly advanced by a player decision. During that advance, the simulation may process NPC activity, scheduled events, emergent consequences, resource changes, relationship changes and other world effects that occur during the elapsed game time. Once that advance completes, the world returns to a paused state.

This means that **paused does not mean inactive in design**. It means the V1 engine is not executing continuously in real time. The world state is persistent and autonomous in its rules and causal structure; execution is simply performed in discrete, player-triggered advancement periods.

V1 Simulation Loop

> **PAUSED → PLAYER DECISION → DETERMINE GAME-TIME COST → ADVANCE WORLD TIME → PROCESS SIMULATION → APPLY CONSEQUENCES → PERSIST WORLD STATE → PAUSED**

A player may choose an action such as travelling, working, talking, resting, waiting or another future action. Each action has a game-time consequence. The simulation advances through the corresponding elapsed period and processes what should happen during that period.

Clarification to “The World Exists Without the Player”

The principle means the player is not the source of the world's existence, activity, relationships or outcomes. It **does not** require V1 to execute an always-running background simulation.

If the player is not currently making a decision, V1 simply retains the last authoritative world state. When the player returns and makes the next decision, the simulation advances from that saved state. A future version may introduce offline or continuously running world progression, but that behavior is explicitly outside the V1 execution model.

Impact on the Foundational Design Rules

Rule	V1 interpretation
The world does not revolve around the player.	Unchanged. The player is one person inside the world.
Relationships exist without the player.	Unchanged. NPC relationships are independent of player interaction.
Time must matter.	Unchanged. Time advances through player decisions and produces consequences.
The future should emerge.	Unchanged. Outcomes are produced by simulation rules, circumstances and decisions.
The world is autonomous.	Autonomy is preserved in world rules and NPC/event behavior during each simulation advance; cor

Status

This amendment is part of the Moh Maya V1 foundational design. It supersedes any interpretation of the V1 Bible that requires continuous, offline, or background simulation. It does not remove the core requirement that Moh Maya behave as a world whose people, relationships and events are not scripted solely around the player.

The terminal/developer interface remains the first testing surface, and the simulation remains independent of presentation.